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Eng508 Solved Final Term Past Papers

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Paper No. 1 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. Define the term "adjacency pairs."

- Adjacency pairs are pairs of related utterances in a conversation, where one speaker's utterance prompts a specific, predictable response from the other speaker. They typically consist of two parts: a first part and a second part. Example: "How are you?" (first part) – "I'm fine, thank you." (second part).

2. What is social deixis? Provide an example.

- Social deixis refers to the use of deictic expressions that indicate social relationships and status among speakers. It includes terms like "sir," "madam," "Mr.," and "Mrs.," which signify respect or hierarchy. Example: "Excuse me, Sir, can I help you?"

3. Explain conceptual meaning.

- Conceptual meaning is the core or literal meaning of a word or phrase, representing its most basic or dictionary definition. It is often associated with cognitive structures that convey specific information.

4. Explain procedural meaning.

- Procedural meaning refers to the use of language to manage conversation, guiding speakers on how to process or interpret the conversation. This can include things like signal words or cues that manage the flow of communication (e.g., "Well," "You know," "Right").

5. Define co-text.

- Co-text refers to the surrounding text or discourse that provides context for interpreting a particular word, phrase, or sentence. It helps clarify the meaning by offering situational or textual support.

6. What is cohesion in discourse?

- Cohesion refers to the grammatical and lexical elements that link parts of a text together, providing structure and continuity. It involves the use of reference, substitution, conjunctions, and other devices to maintain coherence in communication.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Discuss the features and importance of adjacency pairs in conversational analysis.

- Adjacency pairs are essential in conversation analysis because they help structure interactions. They ensure a predictable flow in dialogue, allowing speakers to anticipate responses and maintain coherence.

These pairs involve various forms, such as question-answer, request-offer, greeting-response, and apology-acceptance, which all contribute to the smooth functioning of conversations. They are critical for the orderly exchange of information and serve as a mechanism for managing turn-taking and social interactions.

2. **Explain the difference between direct and indirect speech acts with examples.**

- A **direct speech act** is when the speaker's utterance directly corresponds to its intended function. For example, "Can you pass the salt?" is a request. In an **indirect speech act**, the intention is implied rather than directly stated. For example, "Could you pass the salt?" can function as a polite request even though the literal meaning is a question.

3. **Describe the role of contextual factors in interpreting speech acts.**

- Contextual factors such as the relationship between speakers, their social roles, cultural norms, and the situational context play a vital role in interpreting speech acts. These elements help determine the speaker's intentions, the formality of the language used, and the appropriateness of the response. For example, a request made by a superior may carry more weight than one made by a peer.

4. **Analyze the difference between structural and lexical ambiguity with relevant examples.**

- **Structural ambiguity** occurs when a sentence can be interpreted in more than one way due to its syntactic structure. For example, "I saw the man with the telescope" can imply either that the speaker saw a man who had a telescope or that the speaker used a telescope to see the man. **Lexical ambiguity** arises when a word has multiple meanings. For instance, "bank" could mean a financial institution or the side of a river.

Paper No. 2 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. Define temporal deixis.

- Temporal deixis refers to deictic expressions that indicate time in relation to the speaker's point of reference. It includes words like "now," "then," "today," "tomorrow," and "yesterday."

2. What is the difference between direct and indirect speech?

- **Direct speech** reports someone's words exactly as spoken, e.g., "He said, 'I will come tomorrow.'"
- **Indirect speech** paraphrases or reports the content of someone's speech, e.g., "He said he would come the next day."

3. Explain positive politeness.

- Positive politeness refers to strategies used to show affection, respect, or solidarity with others. It often involves the speaker acknowledging the listener's needs, desires, or interests. For example, "Would you like some coffee?" shows a desire to please.

4. Explain negative politeness.

- Negative politeness involves strategies used to minimize imposition or potential threat to the listener's autonomy. It often includes indirectness, hedging, or offering choices. For example, "I'm sorry to bother you, but could you help me with this?" shows respect for the listener's autonomy.

5. What is a relevance theory?

- Relevance theory, proposed by Sperber and Wilson, suggests that communication is guided by the principle of relevance, meaning that people tend to interpret messages in a way that maximizes cognitive benefit while minimizing effort. It emphasizes the role of context in interpreting meaning.

6. What is structural ambiguity?

- Structural ambiguity arises when a sentence has multiple interpretations due to its syntactic structure, such as a sentence that could be understood in different ways depending on how it is parsed.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Discuss the concept of face and politeness theory, providing examples of face-threatening and face-saving acts.

- The concept of **face** refers to a person's social identity in communication, which is shaped by societal expectations. Politeness theory, developed by Brown and Levinson, argues that people use strategies to maintain or protect face during interactions. **Face-threatening acts** (FTAs) can undermine a person's positive or negative face, such as saying "You look terrible!" to someone (threatening their positive face). **Face-saving acts** (FSAs) aim to protect the listener's face, such as using indirect language or hedging, e.g., "I'm sorry, but I think that could be improved."

2. Compare and contrast positive and negative politeness strategies. Provide examples.

- **Positive politeness** focuses on building rapport and solidarity, e.g., using compliments or inclusive language like "Let's have lunch together!"
- **Negative politeness** focuses on minimizing imposition and respecting autonomy, e.g., "Could you possibly help me with this when you have time?" Positive politeness is more direct and friendly, while negative politeness is more indirect and formal.

3. Explain the different types of deixis (personal, temporal, spatial, social) with examples.

- **Personal deixis** refers to words that indicate participants in communication, such as pronouns ("I," "you," "he," "she").
- **Temporal deixis** refers to expressions that indicate time, such as "now," "soon," "yesterday."
- **Spatial deixis** refers to words that indicate location, such as "here," "there," "above."
- **Social deixis** refers to words that indicate social relationships, such as titles and honorifics ("sir," "ma'am," "Mr.," "Mrs.").

4. Discuss the role of cohesion in discourse, explaining various cohesive devices like reference, substitution, ellipsis, conjunction, and lexical cohesion.

- Cohesion is the use of linguistic elements to connect different parts of a text, ensuring coherence. **Reference** involves using pronouns or determiners to refer to something mentioned earlier (e.g., "John went to the store. He bought some bread."). **Substitution** replaces words with another word (e.g., "I don't like it. He does it"). **Ellipsis** omits words that are understood from the context (e.g., "I want tea, but she wants coffee"). **Conjunction** uses linking words (e.g., "and," "but," "because") to connect ideas. **Lexical cohesion** uses repeated words or synonyms to tie sentences together (e.g., using "dog" and "puppy" to refer to the same concept).

Paper No. 3 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. What is lexical ambiguity?

- Lexical ambiguity occurs when a word has multiple meanings depending on the context. For example, the word "bank" can refer to a financial institution or the side of a river, making it lexically ambiguous.

2. Define cultural pragmatics.

- Cultural pragmatics is the study of how culture influences language use, particularly how different societies use language to convey meaning, manage social interactions, and reflect cultural norms.

3. What is face-threatening act (FTA)?

- A face-threatening act (FTA) refers to any communication that threatens the listener's social identity, or "face." For example, criticizing someone's appearance directly can be an FTA as it undermines their positive face.

4. What is face-saving act (FSA)?

- A face-saving act (FSA) is a strategy employed to protect the face of a speaker or listener. For instance, a speaker may use indirect language, apologize, or hedge to soften the impact of a statement that might threaten someone's face.

5. Explain the maxim of quality.

- The maxim of quality, one of Grice's conversational maxims, asserts that speakers should only say what they believe to be true and avoid providing false or misleading information. For example, saying "I just saw a UFO" implies the speaker believes it to be true.

6. Explain the maxim of relation.

- The maxim of relation, according to Grice's conversational maxims, dictates that speakers should make their contributions relevant to the ongoing conversation. For example, answering "What time is the

meeting?" with "The weather looks nice today" violates the maxim of relation, as the response is not relevant.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Describe Grice's Cooperative Principle and its maxims. Provide examples of how these maxims can be violated.

- Grice's Cooperative Principle is a guideline for effective communication, where speakers assume they are cooperating to make conversation meaningful. It consists of four maxims:
 1. **Maxim of Quantity:** Provide as much information as needed, but no more. Example of violation: "I met him yesterday" (too little information if context requires details).
 2. **Maxim of Quality:** Say only what you believe to be true. Example of violation: "I definitely saw a ghost!" (false information).
 3. **Maxim of Relation:** Make contributions that are relevant. Example of violation: Responding to "How are you?" with "I like chocolate" (irrelevant).
 4. **Maxim of Manner:** Avoid ambiguity and be clear. Example of violation: "I was walking towards the red thing" (ambiguous). Violating these maxims leads to conversational implicature, where speakers infer meaning beyond the literal words.

2. Explain the concept of implicature, distinguishing between conventional implicature and conversational implicature.

- **Implicature** refers to what is implied but not explicitly stated in conversation.
 - **Conventional implicature** arises from the meaning of specific words or phrases (e.g., "but" implies contrast, as in "I wanted to go, but I was tired").

- **Conversational implicature** is derived from the context and Grice's maxims. For example, if someone says "It's cold in here," they may be implying a request to close the window without directly asking.

3. Discuss Austin's and Searle's speech act theories, including the classifications of speech acts.

- Austin's theory of speech acts focuses on the idea that language is used to perform actions. He identified three acts:
 1. **Locutionary act:** The actual utterance (e.g., "I promise to come").
 2. **Illocutionary act:** The intended function of the utterance (e.g., making a promise).
 3. **Perlocutionary act:** The effect the utterance has on the listener (e.g., the listener believes the speaker will come).
- Searle expanded on Austin's work by classifying speech acts into five types:
 1. **Assertives:** Statements that convey information (e.g., "The sky is blue").
 2. **Directives:** Requests or suggestions (e.g., "Close the door").
 3. **Commissives:** Promises or offers (e.g., "I'll help you").
 4. **Expressives:** Expressions of feelings (e.g., "I'm sorry").
 5. **Declarations:** Acts that change the state of affairs (e.g., "I now pronounce you husband and wife").

4. Analyze the impact of cultural differences on speech acts and politeness strategies. Provide examples from different cultures.

- Cultural differences significantly impact how speech acts are performed. For example:

- In **Japanese culture**, indirect speech acts are common to avoid confrontation and preserve harmony, e.g., using "I would appreciate it if you could" instead of directly making a request.
- In **American culture**, directness is often valued, and making direct requests like "Can you help me?" is typical.
- **Politeness strategies** also vary. In **British English**, using indirect expressions like "Would you mind..." or "I wonder if you could..." is common to maintain politeness. In contrast, in **Spanish**, directness may be perceived as rude, and more formal expressions are used when speaking to strangers or elders.

Paper No. 4 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. What is conventional implicature?

- Conventional implicature refers to the meaning that is carried by specific words or phrases in a sentence, independent of the context or conversational maxims. For example, "but" in "He is rich but unhappy" carries an implication of contrast.

2. What are the features of conversational implicature?

- Conversational implicature arises from the context of conversation and Grice's cooperative principle. It occurs when speakers flout one of the maxims (e.g., relevance or quantity), and the listener must infer the intended meaning. For example, "Can you pass the salt?" implicates a request for action, even though the literal question asks about the ability to pass the salt.

3. Define irony in pragmatic terms.

- Irony in pragmatics is when the speaker says something contrary to what they mean, often for humorous or emphatic effect. For example, saying "Oh, great!" when something bad happens conveys the opposite of the literal meaning.

4. What is deixis?

- Deixis refers to words and phrases that cannot be fully understood without additional context, as their meaning depends on who is speaking, when they are speaking, and where they are speaking. Examples include "I," "here," "now."

5. Explain hyperbole with an example.

- Hyperbole is an exaggerated statement used for emphasis or effect. For example, "I've told you a million times" is an exaggeration, not meant to be taken literally.

6. Define presupposition.

- Presupposition refers to background assumptions or shared knowledge that a speaker assumes the listener knows or accepts. For example, "John stopped smoking" presupposes that John once smoked.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Explain the relevance theory proposed by Sperber and Wilson, including its key principles and applications.

- **Relevance theory** posits that communication relies on the principle of relevance, which suggests that people interpret information in ways that maximize cognitive benefit and minimize processing effort. The theory states that the speaker's message should be processed by the listener to yield the most relevant interpretation, considering the context and background knowledge. Key principles include the **Cognitive Principle of Relevance**, which asserts that humans are designed to pay attention to the most relevant information, and the

Communicative Principle of Relevance, which suggests that speakers aim to make their contributions as relevant as possible.

2. **Discuss the difference between presupposition and entailment with suitable examples.**

- **Presupposition** is an assumption that is taken for granted in communication. For example, "John stopped smoking" presupposes that John once smoked.
- **Entailment** refers to what must be true for a statement to be true. For instance, "John is a bachelor" entails that John is unmarried, but the reverse is not necessarily true for presupposition.

3. **Describe the concept of cross-cultural pragmatics and its significance in communication. Provide examples.**

- **Cross-cultural pragmatics** is the study of how different cultures use language to manage social interactions, convey politeness, and interpret meaning. It is significant because it highlights how cultural norms affect communication. For example, in some cultures, directness is valued (e.g., American culture), while in others, indirectness is seen as polite (e.g., Japanese culture). Misunderstandings can arise when speakers from different cultural backgrounds fail to recognize these differences.

4. **Explain the difference between metaphor and synecdoche, providing examples for each.**

- A metaphor is a figure of speech in which one thing is described as another to highlight similarities. For example, "Time is a thief" suggests that time steals moments from life, though it is not literally true.
- A synecdoche is a figure of speech where a part of something represents the whole or vice versa. For example, "All hands on deck" uses "hands" to refer to people.

Paper No. 5 Spring 2024

Total Question:10

Total Marks:27

Attempt Any 4 Question Short And 3 Questions Long:

Short Questions (3 Marks)

1. Define entailment.

- Entailment refers to what must be true if a statement is true. For example, "John is a bachelor" entails that John is unmarried.

2. What is an imposition in the context of politeness?

- An imposition is the act of requesting something that requires the listener to do something that might interrupt their time, efforts, or preferences, potentially threatening their negative face. For example, "Can you help me with this?" might impose on someone's time.

3. Explain Searle's speech act theory.

- Searle's speech act theory classifies speech acts into five categories: assertives, directives, commissives, expressives, and declarations. These categories represent different functions of language used to convey information, request actions, commit to actions, express emotions, and change the status of something.

4. What is substitution in cohesive devices?

- Substitution in cohesive devices involves replacing a part of a sentence with another element to avoid repetition. For example, "I have a car, but I don't like it. It's too old." "It" substitutes for "car."

5. What is ellipsis in cohesive devices?

- Ellipsis is the omission of one or more elements in a sentence because they are understood from the context. For example, "I like tea, and she does [like tea]." The ellipsis removes the repetition of "like tea."

6. What is cross-cultural pragmatics?

- Cross-cultural pragmatics examines how language use differs across cultures, particularly in how politeness strategies, speech acts, and communication norms vary between groups.

Long Questions (5 Marks)

1. Discuss the role of discourse markers in maintaining coherence and cohesion in communication.

- Discourse markers, such as "well," "so," "however," "anyway," play an important role in signaling transitions, shifts, or emphasis in a conversation. They help maintain coherence by guiding the listener through the conversation and showing the relationship between ideas, thus ensuring the conversation flows logically.

2. Explain the concept of social deixis and its relevance in understanding social relationships in communication.

- Social deixis refers to expressions that indicate social relationships and status, such as titles, honorifics, or politeness markers. For example, in English, terms like "sir" or "ma'am" convey respect, while in Japanese, "san" or "sama" are used to denote social distance or respect.

3. Analyze the difference between competitive competence and communicative competence. Provide examples.

- Competitive competence refers to the ability to win or excel in competitive situations, while communicative competence refers to a person's ability to use language effectively in various social contexts. For example, competitive competence might help someone succeed in a debate, whereas communicative competence is essential for successful everyday conversation.

4. Describe the process of conversational implicature generation and recognition, providing examples of generalized and particularized implicatures.

- Conversational implicature is the process by which speakers imply additional meaning beyond the literal interpretation of their words, often based on context. A generalized implicature is one that applies to most conversations, e.g., "Some students passed the test" implies not all students passed. A particularized implicature relies on specific contextual clues, e.g., "Can you pass the salt?" in a particular setting implies a request rather than a question.

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